

AVG pulled up by MS

Microsoft Windows Phone 7 has pulled AVG off from its app marketplace due to location tracking fears



iOS controlled RC car

iW500 remote controlled car which can even scale walls and it is controlled by an iPhone

Feature



Kinect-based games for the Xbox are the latest rage as an activity that can burn calories, not just pile them on.

right hand or head, for example. This is when you can start playing around with the data from Kinect. You can assign the information to a 3D puppet to imitate the user's movements. If you're building an interactive system, the best part is detecting user's gestures. You can't make direct postures to make interaction; it usually has to be gestures like waving your hand, stretching or complicated gestures like drawing some shapes. Though there are some open-source tools to detect gestures from skeleton data, it was tough to find one that worked for our setup, so we decided to write one ourselves. We programmed our system to detect user waving his hands to change TV channels and some complicated gestures like drawing the TV channel logo to jump directly (U for UTV, circle for SunTV, etc). We also tried to get the system to recognise numbers drawn in space. This is probably the most crucial step in the process.

6. Setup: Once you detect gestures successfully, it's time to decide with

which device you want to put your interactive system to work. We did this with a 32-inch HDTV, Tata Sky set-top box and air conditioner. You can combine the interactive system with any day-to-day equipments to manipulate them in ways you've never done before.

7. Universal Infra Red Transceiver (UIRT):

Since most of Harishankar's target devices had IR remote controllers,

he decided to pass the information to those devices using an IR emitter. The best device in the market was USB-UIRT. This device can be connected to your computer via USB and there are drivers available from the manufacturer to make it work with your program. In our case, there was no driver available for Mac computers, so we had to do our own hack again. This device can both, transmit and receive IR signals.

8. Dirty work: Once you've decided which button on the remote to replace with gestures, you need to tap the actual data sent using IR signals from the remote. For this, we wrote a simple program that displays the number (usually hexadecimal combinations) that is being transmitted when each button is pressed on the remote and stored it within our program. Similarly, we tapped the TV remote, Tata Sky remote and air conditioner remote. Almost every device will have a set of unique codes transmitted, so you don't have to worry about multiple devices responding to the same signals.

9. Test: Just to make a quick test you can send the same signal as output using the UIRT device to see if the TV or set-top box responds to your signals. The UIRT device can replace just any IR remote controls and it should work pretty well – it did in my case.

10. Enjoy: Once everything is in place, integrate your gesture recognising code with your UIRT drivers. Now, combine your hardwork so that your program sends a particular signal when it finds the specific gesture through Kinect. Hope this works for you.

OTHER KINECT HACKS

1. Integrating other electronic equipments to replace remote controls and switches.

2. Replacing your computer's mouse and keyboard. Usually works best for a computer connected to a TV in your living room.

3. Allowing your robot to see in the 3D space or making it obey your gesture commands—this is for advanced robotics fanboys.

4. 3D holographic visuals using head tracking.

5. 3D scanning of objects or human face.

6. Virtual Mirrors. You can overlay a funny 3D cartoon character over the user's skeleton on the video to imitate the user's movements. Just imagine Spider-Man doing your movements live when you watch a mirror. You see most laptop's webcams doing this at a micro level.

7. Interactive projectors. Imagine how convenient going through slides will be on a Kinect-controlled smart projector?

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